

3.0 UX Design Brief: IA & Navigation — No-Workspace Variant

🕒 Asset Type	Design Brief
≡ Description	Exploratory IA and navigation brief for OPAQUE 3.0 without the Workspace abstraction. Primary objects: Workflows, Resources (via Registry), and Trust Center.
🕒 Last edited	June 1, 2026 1:57 PM
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⚙️ Status	Not started

⚠️ **Exploratory variant — no Workspaces.** This brief asks: what does the IA look like if we remove Workspaces entirely? The primary objects become **Workflows, Resources** (managed in Registry), and **Trust Center**. Everything is org-scoped. Use this alongside the canonical IA brief to evaluate the trade-offs.

Context

In this model, Workspaces are eliminated as a product concept. There is no governance domain that groups Workflows with Resources or scopes RBAC. Instead:

- **Workflows** are org-level objects. Any Member can view workflows they have been granted access to; Admins and Owners see all.
- **Resources** (Data Sources, Agent Tools, Models, Containers) are registered and managed at the org level in Registry. Access to individual resources is controlled by direct permissions on the resource, not by workspace membership.

- **Trust Center** remains org-wide and is unchanged structurally — it was already workspace-agnostic in the canonical model.

The key questions this variant forces:

1. **What replaces workspace-scoped RBAC?** In the canonical model, a Member's access is defined by workspace membership. Without Workspaces, access must be granted directly on Workflows and Resources — or by group/team. This is a significant governance and product scope question.
2. **What replaces the workspace policy baseline?** Policies that were inherited from a workspace to its Workflows now need a new anchor — either per-Workflow policies only, or an org-level policy baseline that all Workflows inherit.
3. **Does the UX simplify meaningfully for Members?** Members currently navigate a two-level context (org → workspace → workflows). Removing that level may reduce cognitive load — or may make it harder to understand which workflows and resources belong together.

Source PRDs (same as canonical): [Workspaces as Governance Domains](#) · [Trust Center](#) · [BYOW](#) · [OOUX Map](#)

Definitions

Term	Definition	Reference
Workflow	A Studio-built graph that runs at the org level. Can reference Resources directly. Declares a Manifest and has a status (Draft / Deployed). Governed by org-level and per-Workflow policies.	—
Container	A customer-brought containerized workload (BYOW) registered with OPAQUE at the org level. Two-stage lifecycle: Registration (OWD submitted, Manifest generated, governance-approved artifact in Registry) and Permissioning (Container is granted access for use in Workflows by authorized roles).	BYOW PRD
Resource	A passive data asset or service (Data Sources, Agent Tools, or Models) registered in Registry. Referenced by	—

Term	Definition	Reference
	Containers and Workflows. Does not run independently and does not produce attestation.	
Workload	Umbrella term for the two deployable types: Workflows and Containers . Both declare a Manifest, run inside a TEE, and produce an attestation chain at runtime.	Workspaces PRD · BYOW PRD
Manifest	Expected reference measurements generated from the OWD during Container or Workflow registration. Used by the Verifier at runtime.	BYOW PRD · Trust Center PRD
Signed Evidence	Actual measurements of what is running, captured per pod at runtime. Represents "what is running."	Trust Center PRD
Result	Output of the Verifier comparing Manifest (expected) against Signed Evidence (actual). Represents "did they match?"	Trust Center PRD

The attestation chain — **Manifest** → **Signed Evidence** → **Result** — remains the conceptual backbone of Trust Center IA.

Roles

Two roles, unchanged from the canonical model in name — but their access model changes materially without Workspaces.

- **Admin** — org-wide view and management. Can manage all Resources and Containers via Registry, org-level configuration via Org Settings, and user roles. Can access Trust Center.
- **Member** — access to Workflows and Resources granted directly (not via workspace membership). Can access Trust Center. No access to Registry or Org Settings in nav.

Navigation Model

Flat single-group sidebar. Without Workspaces, the two-group sidebar structure (workspace-scoped top / org-scoped bottom) collapses into a single flat list. There is no workspace picker, no scope-switching, and no separator.

Workflows is the home surface. All roles land on the org-wide Workflows list. Members see workflows they have access to; Admins and Owners see all.

Registry and Org Settings remain regular nav items for Admins and Owners, with in-page tabs for sub-sections.

Sidebar states

Owner / Admin

[Cluster Name ▼]

(multi-cluster orgs only)

Workflows

Registry (Containers + Resources)

Trust Center

Org Settings

[User Name ▼]

Member

[Cluster Name ▼]

(multi-cluster orgs only)

Workflows (filtered to accessible workflows)

Trust Center

[User Name ▼]

What's gained vs. lost vs. the canonical model

Dimension	Canonical (with Workspaces)	This variant (no Workspaces)
Nav depth	2 levels (org → workspace)	1 level (org only)
Member orientation	Scoped to assigned workspaces — clear project container	Flat org-wide list — must rely on naming/search
RBAC primitive	Workspace membership	Direct object permissions or groups (TBD)
Policy anchor	Workspace policy baseline → Workflow inheritance	Per-Workflow policies or org-level baseline only

Dimension	Canonical (with Workspaces)	This variant (no Workspaces)
Resource grouping	Resources bound to a workspace = visible in that context	All registered Resources visible; no grouping by project
Sidebar complexity	Picker + two groups + separator	Flat list, no picker
Onboarding	Create workspace first; then assign users, then build	Land directly in Workflows list; no setup gate

Key Surfaces

Workflows

Org-wide list of all Workflows (scoped to access for Members). Status (Draft / Deployed) and Trust status badge per Workflow. No workspace filter — the list is the full org scope. Members who work on distinct projects with no cross-pollination may find this list noisy without a grouping mechanism.

Open question: Does the Workflows list need a first-class grouping or tagging mechanism to replace the organizational role that Workspaces played? Options: tags, folders, owner/team columns, search/filter only.

Resources (via Registry — Admins + Owners)

Registry is unchanged structurally: Containers tab and Resources tab. The key difference is that Resources are no longer "bound to a workspace" — they are org-wide and available to any Workflow that references them. Access control on individual Resources (if any) is an open question.

Containers tab — All registered Containers, their registration status, and last attestation status. BYOW registration flow lives here.

Resources tab — All registered passive Resources (Data Sources, Agent Tools, Models). Available to all Workflows by default (or with direct permission grants — TBD).

Trust Center

Unchanged from the canonical model. Org-wide attestation surface. The workspace filter on the canonical Trust Center becomes a **Workflow filter** or is

removed entirely — since there are no workspaces to filter by. All other Trust Center behavior (Overview, Audit Log, Governance Record export, Dev-mode distinction, progressive disclosure model) carries forward unchanged.

Design direction — progressive disclosure and per-workload Governance Record design directions are unchanged. The label **Governance Record** (vs. AEP in engineering) is unchanged.

Org Settings (Admins + Owners)

Org Settings is unchanged structurally: Users, Policies, General tabs. The difference: **Policies** no longer represents a workspace-level baseline — it is now purely an org-level policy baseline that all Workflows inherit. There is no per-workspace policy inheritance model.

Users — org-wide management of all users and roles. Without workspace membership, this surface also needs to surface how individual Workflow and Resource access is granted (or this moves to the object level — TBD).

Empty states & first-run

No workspace creation gate. Admins and Owners land directly on the Workflows list (empty state: "No workflows yet. Create your first workflow or ask a Builder to get started.") There is no prerequisite setup step before resources or users can be assigned.

Member — no accessible workflows. Empty state: "You don't have access to any workflows yet. Ask an Owner or Admin to grant you access."

Table & Pagination Patterns

Unchanged from the canonical model. Page/offset for studio-plane tables (Workflows, Registry); cursor-based for Audit Log and high-volume time-ordered surfaces.

Design Decisions

The three structural questions raised by removing Workspaces are resolved as explicit deferrals, not open questions. All three are scale problems; we don't have

scale yet.

1. **Access control — defer.** At pre-PMF scale (1–3 builders per proof-of-concept Workflow), flat org-wide access is sufficient. Every user in the org sees all Workflows and Resources they are a Member of the org. No object-level permission grants, no group/team construct. Revisit when a customer has multiple distinct teams that must not see each other's work.
2. **Workflow grouping — defer.** At 1–3 builders per PoC, naming conventions in a flat list are enough. The grouping problem is a scale and multi-team problem. When it becomes real, the right answer (tags, folders, team columns) will be clearer from usage. Don't build structure for a problem we don't have.
3. **Policy baseline — defer.** The workspace policy baseline definition remains unresolved in the canonical model — an indicator that it is not yet load-bearing for early buyers. In this variant, policy is per-Workflow only for now. An org-level policy baseline can be introduced as a distinct feature when the enforcement model is clearly defined and customer demand is validated. This is a deliberate deferral, not an omission.

Appendix: Object Model (No-Workspace Variant)

Canonical hierarchy:

Org → **Workspace** → [**Containers, Workflows**] + [**Data Connectors, Agent Tools, Models**]

No-workspace hierarchy:

Org → [**Workflows, Containers**] + [**Data Sources, Agent Tools, Models**]

All objects are org-level. Grouping (if any) is a presentation layer concern, not a governance domain.

End-to-End User Flow (No-Workspace Variant)

Adapted from the [April engineering onsite flow](#). The canonical flow had 8 steps; two of them — **Create Workspace** and **Share Integration** — exist solely because of the workspace model. Both are removed here. The remaining steps are reframed from the user's perspective.

Roles in this flow

- **Admin** — sets up the org, registers resources, invites users
 - **Builder** — creates and deploys workflows
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Step 1: Login

User authenticates via Auth0. On first login:

- **Admin** lands on the Workflows list (empty state: *"No workflows yet. Start by registering resources in Registry, then create your first workflow."*).
- **Builder (Member)** lands on the Workflows list (empty state: *"No workflows yet. Create your first workflow. Ask your Admin to register resources so you can start building."*).

Step 2: Register Resources (*Admin*)

Admin navigates to **Registry** → **Resources tab** and registers the passive resources Builders will need: Data Sources, Agent Tools, Models.

Once registered, resources are org-wide and immediately available as nodes in Studio for any Builder. No sharing step, no workspace binding.

Step 3: Register Containers (*Admin*)

Admin navigates to **Registry** → **Containers tab** to see registered containers (GA). Registers new BYOW containers via the CLI flow. Registered Containers become available as Studio nodes org-wide, the same as Resources (3.1?). This step is optional for teams not using BYOW.

Step 4: Create a Workflow (*Builder*)

Builder navigates to **Workflows** → **New workflow**, and builds the graph in the Studio canvas. Available nodes are drawn from all registered Resources and Containers in Registry — no workspace filter, no binding step.

Builder saves the workflow graph as a draft.

Step 5: Deploy Workflow (*Builder or Admin*)

User triggers deployment. Workflow status updates to **Deployed**. Workload is invocable by Builder or downstream users.

Step 6: Review Trust (*Admin or Builder*)

User navigates to **Trust Center**. The workflow appears in the org-wide workload list. Drill down: workflow → pod → policy dimension → decision.

Admin or Builder can export the result from the per-pod row in the workflow detail view.